

Growth at Glean

Overview

I led design for Growth as Glean scaled from 25K to more than 1M weekly active users.

The work focused on helping users move from trying Glean to returning to it. The strongest ideas helped users do something useful quickly, then made the next action easy to see.

I was the Growth product designer on a cross-functional team. I worked across onboarding, Starter Kit, the Keep It page, extension adoption, social proof, and product education.

[PLACEHOLDER: HERO PRODUCT SCREENS]

Real product screens from onboarding, Starter Kit, and Keep It.

Team

Arpit Agrawal, Product Manager

Ben McMahan, Engineer

Sarah Di, Engineer

Edward Hwang, Engineer

Neel Saswade, Designer

Chat-first onboarding

Helping users reach value faster

I helped move onboarding from a search-first flow toward guided Chat, persona-based queries, follow-up actions, and Starter Kit content.

The sales-focused direction showed early gains in Week 2 active rate and Week 1 chats, supporting more relevant onboarding for different roles.

[PLACEHOLDER: ONBOARDING PRODUCT FLOW]

Show 3–5 real screens from the first query through the first useful result.

[PLACEHOLDER: PERSONA-BASED SCREENS]

Show one comparison of onboarding for two roles.

The Keep It page

A focused retention win

I redesigned the moment when users decided whether to keep Glean in their workflow. The work clarified the value of staying installed and made the next action easier to understand.

Keep rate improved by about 9.09 percentage points.

[PLACEHOLDER: KEEP IT PRODUCT SCREENS]

Show the old and new screens side by side, with short captions for the key changes.

[PLACEHOLDER: PUBLIC RESULT CALLOUT]

+ $[X]$ percentage points Keep rate

Replace with the approved public result.

Starter Kit

Teaching Glean through work

The Starter Kit took several rounds to find the right shape. I explored placement, progress, copy, task structure, and its relationship to the homepage and left navigation.

The final direction used short tasks to help users find information, use Chat, discover expertise, and create something useful. The left-nav version gave the experience a persistent home after onboarding.

Starter Kit completion became a strong directional signal for Week 2 and longer-term retention.

[PLACEHOLDER: STARTER KIT PRODUCT EVOLUTION]

Show an early exploration, selected direction, and shipped left-nav version.

[PLACEHOLDER: FINAL STARTER KIT SCREEN]

Show the final task list with short captions for each task.

Extension adoption and social proof

I worked on extension prompts, install timing, messaging, and social proof. In one onboarding experiment, social proof increased extension promo opt-in by 1.59 percentage points.

The design lesson was clear: social proof worked best when it reduced uncertainty and showed users what to do next.

[PLACEHOLDER: EXTENSION PRODUCT SCREEN]

Show the social proof treatment in its real product context.

The broader Growth system

The wider work included manager invites, managed Chrome, lifecycle email, homepage Chat discovery, artifact sharing, proactive cards, experiment readouts, and activation dashboards.

[PLACEHOLDER: SUPPORTING PRODUCT SCREEN STRIP]

Use 4–6 real product screens labeled Invites, Extension, Email, Homepage, Artifacts, and Experiments.

Impact

Glean grew from 25K to more than 1M weekly active users during this period. The Keep It redesign improved Keep rate by about 9.09 percentage points. Social proof increased extension promo opt-in by 1.59 percentage points. Starter Kit completion became a strong directional signal for retention.

[PLACEHOLDER: IMPACT PRODUCT SCREEN]

Pair one approved metric with the product screen most directly connected to it.

What I learned

Start with the behavior

The strongest Growth concepts began with a user action.

Make value visible

Placement, hierarchy, and timing often mattered more than adding more copy.

Design for the return visit

Activation becomes more durable when the product gives users a clear reason to return.

Before publishing

Replace the placeholders with real product screens and confirm that every metric is approved for public use.

Co-authored with Glean